TUESDAY, 3 NOVEMBER 2026

ALWAYS FREE

Inside Desk

EVENING EPAPER

PUBLISHED 17:30 CET · BERLIN

LEAD · ORDINARY & INHERITED LIFE

4.09% in a draft, €78.30 a month, and the number that decides it is still on next spring's payslips

The government's first estimate for next July's pension rise arrived on Tuesday. It is a good number. It is also a forecast, and the one made a year ago was half a point too low.

> The government pencilled in a 4.09% pension rise for next July, and the formula will check it against this year's pay in spring. Elsewhere: a president's claim about Hormuz against a ship count, Wednesday's power price slipping below €250, an early flu season, 23 inches of rain on Florida's polling day, and a likely Bank of England rise on Thursday.

Read the lead →

Go to page 4 →

Pensions could rise about 4% next July, but the real number will be worked out in spring from what people actually earned this year.

ALSO INSIDE · 33 PIECES

7 POLITICS & INSTITUTIONS
Podium vs Print: "we control the Strait of Hormuz" and five crossings by teatime

9 PSYCHOLOGY & BEHAVIOUR
931 voters, one night's dreams, and a morning that felt worse

11 MONEY, FX & COMMITTEES
3.75% to 4.0% on Thursday, and the harder question is what comes after

12 ORDINARY & INHERITED LIFE
€1.70 a litre for heating oil, about 80 cents more than a year ago, and a dealer who says buy part

GEO-ECONOMICS · P. 5
$30 billion each way, no date in the gazette, and 178 exclusions that lapse on 10 November

MARKETS & MACRO · P. 6
DAX down 0.3%, Bayer up more than 6%, and Apple's best year met a margin forecast

ENERGY & INDUSTRY · P. 10
€248.99: Wednesday's power slips under €250, and the wind came back on land

CLIMATE & WEATHER · P. 16
23.69 inches in Grant-Valkaria: a 1-in-100 flood on the Space Coast, on polling day

THE DAY IN ONE SENTENCE

Pensions could rise about 4% next July, but the real number will be worked out in spring from what people actually earned this year.

Read this edition in reading view →

In this issue

3 LATEST
Latest

4 LEAD
4.09% in a draft, €78.30 a month, and the number that decides it is still on next spring's payslips

5 GEO-ECONOMICS · 3 PIECES
$30 billion each way, no date in the gazette, and 178 exclusions that lapse on 10 November

6 MARKETS & MACRO · 3 PIECES
DAX down 0.3%, Bayer up more than 6%, and Apple's best year met a margin forecast

7 POLITICS & INSTITUTIONS · 3 PIECES
Podium vs Print: "we control the Strait of Hormuz" and five crossings by teatime

9 PSYCHOLOGY & BEHAVIOUR · 3 PIECES
931 voters, one night's dreams, and a morning that felt worse

10 ENERGY & INDUSTRY · 3 PIECES
€248.99: Wednesday's power slips under €250, and the wind came back on land

11 MONEY, FX & COMMITTEES · 3 PIECES
3.75% to 4.0% on Thursday, and the harder question is what comes after

12 ORDINARY & INHERITED LIFE · 3 PIECES
4.09% in a draft, €78.30 a month, and the number that decides it is still on next spring's payslips

13 TECH & COMPUTE · 3 PIECES
51% not Chinese: Nvidia's new rule for the clouds, given by word of mouth

14 HEALTH & CARE · 3 PIECES
225, 305, 360: the flu came early, and the jab fits

15 SECURITY & ORDER · 3 PIECES
50°C in the freezers, ten countries, and a patch from August

16 CLIMATE & WEATHER · 3 PIECES
23.69 inches in Grant-Valkaria: a 1-in-100 flood on the Space Coast, on polling day

17 CHARTS AND DATA
Charts and data

18 BACK PAGE
Before you close the tab

THIS ISSUE

The government pencilled in a 4.09% pension rise for next July, and the formula will check it against this year's pay in spring. Elsewhere: a president's claim about Hormuz against a ship count, Wednesday's power price slipping below €250, an early flu season, 23 inches of rain on Florida's polling day, and a likely Bank of England rise on Thursday.

11 edition pieces · 11 desks · Published 17:30 CET, 3 November 2026

22 ePaper extras, added 17:30 CET, 3 November. They appear only in the ePaper and carry their own time.

The website edition

THE EPAPER RHYTHM

06:30 Morning ePaper (website edition at 08:30)

17:30 Evening ePaper, updated live until 22:30 with an “Updated” time and a Latest page

Sun 10:00 The Sunday Magazine

Berlin time. Every issue is free.

HOW TO READ IT

Swipe, use the arrow keys or the page strip. Tap any headline for the reading view. Press / to search, t for contents, + / - to zoom. Download the PDF.

Latest

Live: this page and the issue are updated until 22:30 Berlin time.

17:30 Evening ePaper published. No updates yet.

ORDINARY & INHERITED LIFE · LEAD · 3 MIN

4.09% in a draft, €78.30 a month, and the number that decides it is still on next spring's payslips

The government's first estimate for next July's pension rise arrived on Tuesday. It is a good number. It is also a forecast, and the one made a year ago was half a point too low.

On Tuesday afternoon the labour ministry sent its draft pension insurance report for 2026 to the other ministries for comment, and two newspapers had read it within the hour[1,2]. The headline is generous: Germany's roughly 21 million statutory pensioners could get a rise of 4.09% on 1 July 2027[1,2].

In money, that means the value of one pension point would go from €42.52 to €44.26 a month[1]. For the textbook "standard pensioner" with 45 years of average contributions, the gross pension would rise from about €1,913 to €1,992, or €78.30 a month, Reuters reported[1,2]. The FAZ puts it more usefully for everybody else: about €41 more for every €1,000 of monthly pension[2]. The government expects prices to rise by 3% in 2027, so on these figures the rise would again run ahead of inflation[1].

Now the part the headline leaves out. **This is an estimate, not a decision.** The actual figure is normally fixed in March, once the final wage statistics for 2026 are in, by a government ordinance that the Bundesrat must approve[2,3]. And estimates move. A year ago the government expected 3.73% for this July; pensions actually rose by 4.24%, half a point more[1]. The formula does not care what anyone says in November. It reads what employers paid in wages.

ORDINARY · PENSIONS

Seven Julys of pension rises, one of them zero

Statutory pension adjustment on 1 July, West Germany until 2023, nationwide from 2024, %

▶ Data table

Source: Deutsche Rentenversicherung, Rentenversicherung in Zeitreihen 2025 and press release of 5 March 2026, as tabulated by finanzfacts.de (Stand 23 Oct 2026), retrieved 3 Nov 2026 · Official adjustment rates, freely usable · Actual adjustments only; the 4.09% estimate for 2027 is not drawn. · CSV

That is the dull machinery worth admiring. In 2026 the wage factor alone would have produced a rise of 4.25%; the sustainability factor, which weighs pensioners against contributors, would have pulled it down to 4.05%, and only the 48% "holding line" agreed in 2025 kept it at 4.24%[3]. Over 35 years, the pension point in the West rose by 100.7% while consumer prices rose by 101.9%[3]. That is not a windfall. It is a long, unglamorous promise to keep pace, mostly kept, with the bad year in plain view: in July 2021, after wages fell in 2020, the West got nothing[3].

The other side of the payslip. The same draft says what it costs. The contribution rate stays at 18.6% of gross pay until the end of 2027, then rises to 19.7% in 2028 and 19.8% in 2029, slightly less than the pension insurer itself expected in spring[2]. The reserve does the waiting in between: €41.4 billion at the end of 2025, an expected €31.2 billion at the end of this year, which is just under one month's spending, and about €12.1 billion at the end of 2027[1]. Without the higher rate in 2028, Reuters reports, the reserve would then fall below its legal minimum[1].

The holding line is not free either. The federal budget's refunds for keeping the pension level at 48% are put at €1.7 billion in 2027 and €13.2 billion in 2031, after which the draft sees the level drifting down to 46.5% by 2040 under current law[1]. …

Continue in reading view →

WHAT TO WATCH

- March 2027, when the labour ministry normally fixes the actual July rise from final wage data; the Bundesrat then has to agree.
- The coalition's planned pension reform, which the draft's long-range figures do not yet include.

DESK COMMENT

A pension rise is not granted at a podium. It is worked out from last year's payroll.

GEO-ECONOMICS · 2 MIN

$30 billion each way, no date in the gazette, and 178 exclusions that lapse on 10 November

The US-China tariff truce has a framework, a board and a list of toys. What it does not yet have is the dull notice that makes a customs officer charge less.

In late September, after their eighth round of talks, Washington and Beijing agreed a "30-for-30" framework: roughly $30 billion of each side's imports would lose the extra tariffs, with more than 90% of the listed products going back to normal most-favoured-nation rates[2]. The US side covers things you can wrap: toys, home appliances, baby products, kitchenware, holiday gifts. China's side covers American farm goods, personal-care products, medical devices and coal[2].

The consultations on the lists ended on 31 October, East Asia Brief reported on Monday[1]. The US relief list runs to 77 tariff categories, almost all of them finished consumer goods. China's runs to more than 1,600 tariff lines[1]. Both lists leave out the things factories actually buy from each other: intermediate electronics, lithium-ion battery cells, chemical precursors and chip-making tools[1].

Now the dull part. Both governments must finish their domestic legal procedures before the cuts take effect, and the cuts are to start at the same time on both sides[2]. As of Monday, no Federal Register notice had been published and no start date set, so US importers keep paying the current duties[1]. Meanwhile a separate clock is running: temporary Section 301 exclusions for 178 categories of industrial equipment expire on 10 November unless USTR extends them[1]. The wider truce runs to 10 January 2027[1].

What this means for you: if you sell Christmas decorations or kettles from China, relief is coming, but not on any date you can put in a contract yet. If you buy packaging lines, power tools or factory automation, the date that matters is next Tuesday, and it could move your costs the other way. A framework is a promise. The customs schedule is the invoice. Nothing here is investment advice.

WHAT TO WATCH

- 10 November: whether USTR renews the temporary Section 301 exclusions on 178 categories of industrial equipment.
- A Federal Register notice, and its Chinese counterpart, giving the 30-for-30 cuts an actual start date.

DESK COMMENT

A trade deal is announced at a podium and begins in a gazette. Until the gazette, the old tariff is the price.

GEO-ECONOMICS · SHORT ITEM · EPAPER EXTRA, ADDED 17:30 CET

General License 135: legal in one rulebook, still caught in three others

Washington has loosened its grip on Russian diesel. A sanctions lawyer's note explains why the cargo may still not move.

The US Treasury's sanctions office has issued General License 135, and the president has used a waiver under this year's Russia and Iran sanctions act[1]. Together they authorise some sale, delivery, offloading and import of Russian-origin diesel that the sanctions regulations would otherwise forbid[1]. With diesel dear, traders are asking whether the trade is open again.

A note from the law firm Seyfarth Shaw, published on Monday, is a useful corrective[1]. First, the licence "does not necessarily override" the Ending Importation of Russian Oil Act, a separate statute whose restrictions can only be lifted with notice to Congress and a chance for Congress to object[1]. Second, the EU, the UK and others keep their own restrictions, and a diesel cargo touches banks, insurers, shipowners and ports, each under its own regime. There is "little indication" that key allies plan to relax theirs[1]. …

Continue in reading view →

GEO-ECONOMICS · BRIEF · EPAPER EXTRA, ADDED 17:30 CET

6,165 tonnes of magnets: Europe got 20.5% more, Japan 19.1% less

China exported 6,165 tonnes of rare-earth permanent magnets in September, the most this year and 23% more than in August, according to Shanghai Metals Market's reading of customs data[1]. The EU took 2,454 tonnes, up 20.5% and its most since February, after an October deal promising a licence "green channel" for European buyers[1]. Japan's share fell 19.1% to 172 tonnes amid a diplomatic impasse[1]. US imports for January to September were about 15% below the same months of 2024, the Silverado Policy Accelerator found[1]. The magnets go into car motors, wind turbines and robots. October's customs figures are due in the coming days, and they will show whether September was a backlog clearing or a new normal[1]. Nothing here is investment advice.

MARKETS & MACRO · 2 MIN

DAX down 0.3%, Bayer up more than 6%, and Apple's best year met a margin forecast

Europe drifted a fraction lower into its close, New York opened split down the middle, and the day's real verdicts came from the earnings tables rather than the polling stations.

Frankfurt did not wait for America. By about 16:08 CET the DAX stood at 25,913.40, down 0.27% on the day[3], having touched 25,677.86 in the morning[1]; Monday's close was 25,981.09[1]. Xetra's official close comes at 17:30, after this was written. The Stoxx Europe 600 was 0.4% lower at 647.13 by mid-morning, with technology the heaviest drag, down 1.6%, STMicro and ASML lower, as worries about AI valuations and fresh US strikes on Iran's Qeshm Island kept buyers cautious[2].

The exception was the dullest kind of good news. Bayer raised its full-year guidance for core profit (EBITDA before special items) to €9.8bn–€10.3bn, from €9.6bn–€10.1bn, on the back of an 8% rise in pharmaceutical sales, and the shares were up more than 6% in afternoon trading[3]. Two drugs, Nubeqa and Kerendia, grew 58.3% and 64.9% after adjustments[3]. A turnaround is not a speech. It is a column of prescriptions that keeps getting longer.

New York opened split in two. In the first hour the Dow was down 0.3%, the S&P 500 up 0.2% and the Nasdaq up 0.5%, as chip stocks recovered from a rough few days[4]. Apple fell more than 2% after its first report under its new chief executive, John Ternus: revenue beat estimates, but iPad sales missed and the margin forecast disappointed, with higher memory costs named as the main pressure[5]. Palantir fell even though revenue nearly doubled; the market looked past the quarter at the contracts behind it (see the ePaper)[5].

The lesson for you is an old one. A company can have, as Ternus put it, its "best fiscal year ever" and still go down, because the price already counted on it[5]. Nothing here is investment advice.

WHAT TO WATCH

- AMD reports after the New York close tonight (from about 22:00 CET); guidance matters more than the quarter.
- Polls close from 00:00 CET. Prices at Wednesday's open will react to counts, not to forecasts.

DESK COMMENT

A market that waits for an election still has to read the invoices in the meantime.

MARKETS & MACRO · SHORT ITEM · EPAPER EXTRA, ADDED 17:30 CET

Revenue up nearly 100%, contracts up 11%: why Palantir fell on a beat

The quarter was a blowout; the forward order book was not, and the shares followed the order book.

Palantir's revenue nearly doubled from a year ago and passed $2 billion in a quarter for the first time[1]. For the first time, its US commercial revenue also beat its government revenue[1]. The shares fell about 5% anyway[1], and were still lower once New York opened[2].

The reason sits in one dull line: total contract value, the deals signed for the future. In US commercial business Palantir closed $1.5 billion of it, up 11% on a year earlier. In the second quarter the same figure was a record $2.1 billion, up 153%[1]. Revenue tells you what was delivered. Contracts tell you what has been promised next.

Analysts were not alarmed. Goldman Sachs noted that the company put part of the slowdown down to shorter contract durations, and said the key will be turning those into longer commitments, "which Palantir has done successfully in the past"[1]. Piper Sandler said demand "still very much" outstrips supply[1].

So both readings can be true. The business is growing fast, and the price had already assumed it would keep growing faster. When a share is priced for perfection, a good quarter is not enough; the next three have to be signed too. For you, the useful habit is to read the order book before the headline. Nothing here is investment advice.

MARKETS & MACRO · BRIEF · EPAPER EXTRA, ADDED 17:30 CET

$13 billion expected from AMD tonight, and $8.19 billion of it from data centres

AMD reports after New York closes tonight. Analysts expect earnings of $1.97 a share on revenue of $13 billion, against $1.20 and $9.2 billion a year ago, according to Bloomberg consensus[1]. Data centres should bring in $8.19 billion, up 88%; gaming is expected to fall 49% to $655 million as memory shortages push up prices[1].

The shares rose more than 4% early on Tuesday[1]. Last week Intel beat on the quarter, gave a fourth-quarter range of $15–16 billion against $17 billion expected, and fell nearly 29%[1]. That is the bar: the forecast for the next quarter, not the result for the last one. Nothing here is investment advice.

POLITICS & INSTITUTIONS · PODIUM VS PRINT · 2 MIN

Podium vs Print: "we control the Strait of Hormuz" and five crossings by teatime

On the eve of the midterms the president said the waterway was in hand. The ship counters and the shipping regulator kept a different ledger.

PODIUM

“We control the Strait of Hormuz. We control it, and strongly control it.”

Donald Trump, US president, in his closing pre-midterm remarks at the Lincoln Memorial, Monday 2 November 2026, the eve of election day

PRINT

5 vs 84.8

AIS-visible commercial crossings so far on election day, against a pre-crisis average of 84.8 a day; the rolling seven-day average is 9.0.

hormuz.now AIS crossing count for Tuesday 3 November, against its pre-crisis baseline, Tuesday 3 November 2026, updated 16:24 CET

The podium. On Monday, standing in front of the newly reopened Reflecting Pool, the president gave his closing message before today’s midterms[1,4]. Among the reflecting-pool joints and the grass, he turned to the Gulf: “We control the Strait of Hormuz. We control it, and strongly control it.” He added that, as the Wall Street Journal had reported, the United States “took out last week more oil than at any time in the history of the Strait”[1]. We have not been able to check that report, so we leave it to the Journal.

The print. The dull count is easier to check. By 16:24 Berlin time today, the tracker hormuz.now had logged five AIS-visible commercial crossings since midnight UTC: two inbound, three outbound, two of them tankers[2]. Its rolling seven-day average is 9.0 crossings a day. Its pre-crisis baseline is 84.8[2]. Desk arithmetic: the week’s traffic is running at about a tenth of normal. The counter warns that its day is still in progress, and ships with their transponders off are not in it. The official IMF PortWatch figure lags by days[2].

The regulator. The shipping world’s own institution was blunter on Monday. Arsenio Dominguez, secretary-general of the International Maritime Organization, said there was “no confirmation that there are no mines in the region” and that the IMO was “not recommending anyone to go through the Strait of Hormuz”[3]. The designated lanes are not in operation. Ships that do cross use routes north through Iranian waters or south near Oman with US naval escorts, arrangements the IMO has not adopted[3]. He counted about 30 attacks on ships in and around the strait in October, and about 6,000 seafarers still aboard 350 to 400 ships in the Gulf[3].

The gap. Both statements can be partly true. Escorts are a form of control, and the president’s own speech said a deal “could happen”[1]. But control that moves a tenth of the usual traffic is control of a corridor, not of a market. For you, the useful number is not the adjective. It is the crossing count, and the day the IMO changes its advice. Polls close from midnight Berlin time; this desk makes no forecast about them.

POLITICS & INSTITUTIONS · SHORT ITEM · EPAPER EXTRA, ADDED 17:30 CET

Brussels on Wednesday, Abu Dhabi on the 10th, Berlin on the 19th

Zelenskyy came to Berlin unannounced, and the most useful thing he brought was a calendar.

Volodymyr Zelenskyy flew to Berlin today on a trip that had not been announced, and stood beside Friedrich Merz at the chancellery[1]. The words were familiar. Merz said Ukraine “can continue to rely on Germany”, with more help on air defence, energy and winter aid in the coming months[1]. Zelenskyy said that while many eyes are on America’s election, “the role of Europe – and specifically Germany – remains crucial”[1].

The dates are what you can hold them to. On Wednesday the European Commission hosts a meeting with Ukraine, the United States, France, Germany, the UK, NATO and the World Bank, at national-security-adviser level, on post-war reconstruction and “prosperity”, spokesperson Paula Pinho said[2]. On 10–11 November, US envoy Steve Witkoff has announced talks in Abu Dhabi that the Kremlin has confirmed[1,2]. On 19 November the coalition of the willing meets in Berlin, and Merz said that meeting will decide further support for Ukraine in 2027[1].

Zelenskyy called a Russian suggestion of talks in Moscow “counterproductive”[1]. Merz said it was “crucial for Russia to finally engage in serious negotiations”[1]. Speeches are cheap; meetings with agendas, minutes and a World Bank seat at the table are not. Three of them are now in the diary.

WHAT TO WATCH

- IMF PortWatch's official transit count, which runs several days behind; its latest published day is 25 October.
- Whether the IMO revises its advice against transiting once the traffic separation scheme is confirmed clear of mines.

DESK COMMENT

A strait is controlled when the insurers say so, and the insurers read the ship counts, not the speeches.

POLITICS & INSTITUTIONS · BRIEF · EPAPER EXTRA, ADDED 17:30 CET

324 against, 25 for: Sweden's second try at a government fails

Sweden's parliament today rejected the Centre Party leader, Elisabeth Thand Ringqvist, as prime minister by 324 votes to 25[1]. She had said herself that she had no chance. It is the second failed attempt to form a government in the 51 days since the election[1]. The rules are plain: after four failed votes, Sweden holds a snap election. The interim centre-right prime minister, Ulf Kristersson, is expected to lead the next attempt, though his outgoing coalition is also short of a majority[1]. That is not chaos. A constitution that counts the attempts and names what happens at four is doing exactly what it was written to do.

PSYCHOLOGY & BEHAVIOUR · 2 MIN

931 voters, one night's dreams, and a morning that felt worse

A study of the 2024 election night found that dreaming about the result went with sharper feelings the next day, not softer ones. Tonight is a good night to know it.

Polls in America start closing at midnight Berlin time, and many people will go to bed not knowing the result. A study reported on Monday asks what that night does to them[1]. William Livingston, Adam Putnam and Erin Wamsley surveyed 931 American adults twice: on the morning of election day, 5 November 2024, and again between 8:00 and 9:54 Eastern time the next morning, after the Associated Press had called the race[1]. The paper is published in PLOS One.

About 71% recalled a dream from election night, and 49% of those said it was about the election[1]. An AI classifier, checked against human raters, put the share at 44%, and nearly a quarter of all dreams referred directly to the candidates or campaign imagery[1].

The researchers expected the old idea to hold: that dreaming softens emotional reactions overnight. It did not. Among people who recalled a dream, those who dreamed about the election showed a larger negative shift in how they felt about it[1]. The effect came from Democrats and, less strongly, Independents; Republicans felt the same whether or not they dreamed of it[1]. Democrats who dreamed of the election also woke up gloomier about their own future and the country's[1]. Simply recalling some dream, about anything, made no difference[1].

Read it with the caveats the authors give. It is correlational: people more invested in the result, or watching coverage until late, may be both likelier to dream of it and likelier to feel strongly[1]. Everything was self-reported, sleep was not measured, and it covers a single night[1]. The links were small across the whole sample, moderate within the two groups[1].

What you can take from it is modest and practical. Your mood at breakfast tomorrow is not a verdict on the country. Feelings run hot the morning after; the counting, by law, runs for weeks. If you can, switch off before the last result, sleep, and judge the news on the second day rather than the first.

WHAT TO WATCH

- Whether the authors or others repeat the design for tonight's midterms, ideally with sleep measured rather than only reported.

DESK COMMENT

Sleep on it, says the proverb. The data say: sleep, yes; the dream is optional, and not always a friend.

PSYCHOLOGY & BEHAVIOUR · SHORT ITEM · EPAPER EXTRA, ADDED 17:30 CET

Your opponents are more open-minded than you think, and 120 students proved it

Four studies in Portugal and Sweden found people badly underestimate how willing the other side is to listen. Showing them the real answers helped.

A team led by André Mata at the University of Lisbon, with colleagues at Linköping University, asked a plain question: do we avoid political conversations because we assume the other side won't listen?[1] The work is in the Journal of Experimental Social Psychology.

In surveys of 198 people in Portugal and 402 in Sweden, participants rated their own willingness to hear contrary views, then guessed how supporters of their least liked party would answer[1]. They rated themselves as more receptive than average and consistently underestimated their opponents, when set against those opponents' actual self-reports[1]. The lower the guess, the more frustrating and stressful a conversation was expected to be, and the less willing people were to have one[1].

Continue in reading view →

PSYCHOLOGY & BEHAVIOUR · BRIEF · EPAPER EXTRA, ADDED 17:30 CET

7,434 Australians, two decades, and no 'loneliness cliff' at retirement

Monash University researchers followed 7,434 Australians aged 55 to 75 for nearly two decades in the HILDA household survey[1]. Loneliness did not change in the three years before retirement or the three years after, said the lead author, Johannes Kunz[1]. That held across income, wealth and job type, with or without grandchildren, volunteering or clubs[1]. About one in six (17.5%) reported often feeling very lonely[1]. Loneliness rises steadily from the late 60s, Kunz said, and losing a spouse matters more than leaving a job, so support should follow later life, not the retirement date[1]. The paper is in Scientific Reports. For pension-age debates, one worry can be crossed off the list.

ENERGY & INDUSTRY · 2 MIN

€248.99: Wednesday's power slips under €250, and the wind came back on land

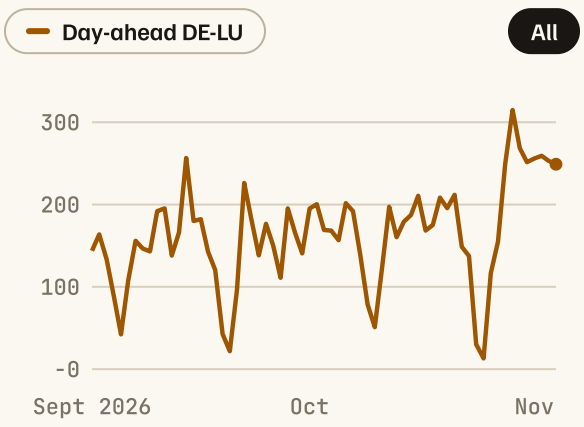
Six delivery days above €250 end by €1.01, and Tuesday's turbines made as much power by mid-afternoon as Monday's did all day.

The streak is over, though only just. Today's day-ahead auction set an average of €248.99 per megawatt hour for Germany and Luxembourg for delivery on Wednesday 4 November, the desk's average of the 24 hourly results that SMARD published this afternoon[1]. That is €3.86 below Tuesday's €252.85 and the first delivery day under €250 since 28 October[1]. The six days in between all cleared above it, peaking at €314.85 on Thursday 29 October[1].

ENERGY · POWER

Six days above €250, then €248.99

Germany/Luxembourg day-ahead electricity price, daily average by delivery day, € per MWh



▶ Data table (latest values)

Source: Bundesnetzagentur | SMARD.de, day-ahead price DE-LU (filter 4169), delivery days 1 Sep to 4 Nov 2026; 4 Nov is the desk average of the 24 hourly results of the 3 Nov auction, retrieved 3 Nov 2026, 16:25 CET · CC BY 4.0 · CSV

Don't mistake a dip for a turn. Wednesday's hourly prices still run from €209.12 for the 03:00 hour to €310.92 for 17:00[1]. Desk arithmetic: the average is still about 61% above the €155.11 of Tuesday 27 October, the last day before the calm set in[1]. You are not looking at cheap power. You are looking at slightly less dear power.

Continue in reading view →

WHAT TO WATCH

- Whether the wind holds through Wednesday: SMARD's provisional generation figures for the full day appear on Thursday morning.
- Wednesday's evening peak: the auction still cleared €310.92 for 17:00 and €300.01 for 18:00.

DESK COMMENT

A streak is a headline; a dollar under it is a ledger. Read the ledger.

ENERGY & INDUSTRY · SHORT ITEM · EPAPER EXTRA, ADDED 17:30 CET

5,160 megawatts for €155,296 apiece: the first bill for Germany's backup plants

The first auction for standby power came in well under its price cap, and you will pay for it through a levy from 2031.

The grid regulator has put a price on Germany's insurance against windless winter nights. The Bundesnetzagentur awarded 11 contracts for about 5,160 megawatts of new plants in its first auction for backup capacity, tagesschau reported on Tuesday[1]. All of it went to gas-fired projects, most of them to RWE and LEAG[2].

The useful numbers are the dull ones. The average award was €155,296 per megawatt of creditable capacity per year, well below the cap of €244,000[1]. …

Continue in reading view →

ENERGY & INDUSTRY · BRIEF · EPAPER EXTRA, ADDED 17:30 CET

Ten hours at 80%: why no battery won a contract

The rule decided the result before the bids did. Plants in Germany's first backup auction had to deliver 80% of their capacity for at least ten hours in a row, which made gas far more competitive than battery storage, Clean Energy Wire reported[1]. Battery projects bid; the economy ministry said none "prevailed in the price competition"[1].

Some winners are not new plants at all: LEAG will convert lignite units at Jänschwalde and Boxberg to gas[1]. Converted coal units run at 40 to 45% efficiency against about 60% for modern gas plants, the Frankfurter Allgemeine reported, as cited by Clean Energy Wire[1].

The design changes next spring. A 2,000-megawatt round in May 2027 drops the ten-hour rule[2]. You will be able to see then what batteries bid when the rules let them.

MONEY, FX & COMMITTEES · 2 MIN

3.75% to 4.0% on Thursday, and the harder question is what comes after

The Bank of England is expected to make its first hike since 2023; the argument is about the three or four that markets have already pencilled in.

On Thursday the Bank of England is expected to raise Bank Rate to 4.0% from 3.75%. Economists polled by Reuters expect it, and it would be the first increase since August 2023[1]. The reason is energy. Consumer prices rose 3.5% in the year to September, against the Bank's July forecast of 3.0%, and in September it warned that inflation would rise above 4% early next year[1].

The Committee is not of one mind. It voted 6–3 to hold in September, and the Reuters poll points to 7–2 for a hike this time, with the external members Alan Taylor and Swati Dhingra seen as the likeliest to vote for no change[1]. "Their hands are increasingly being forced, whether they like it or not," said Stefan Koopman of Rabobank[1].

The interesting part is what comes next. Markets price three to four more quarter-point hikes in 2027, which would take Bank Rate to between 4.75% and 5.0%[1]. Even the hawks may not want to sign up to that. Oxford Economics thinks the minutes, or the Governor, Andrew Bailey, may signal that the rate is unlikely to reach the level priced in[1]. Catherine Mann has argued that part of that pricing is a risk premium the Bank created itself by waiting and seeing[1].

There is a quieter test as well: the Bank's first assessment of the budget John Healey presented last week, whose help for households and drivers economists expect to shave only a little off inflation[1]. Forecasts, votes and a budget check all arrive at 13:00 CET on Thursday. If you have a tracker mortgage or a savings account in sterling, that is your appointment. Nothing here is investment advice.

WHAT TO WATCH

- Thursday 5 Nov, 13:00 CET: Bank of England decision, minutes and forecasts; press conference at 13:30 CET.
- The vote split and the individual members' statements, which say more about 2027 than the headline rate.

DESK COMMENT

A central bank earns credibility in the meeting where it does what it said, and keeps it in the meeting where it says no more than it means.

MONEY, FX & COMMITTEES · SHORT ITEM · EPAPER EXTRA, ADDED 17:30 CET

Bunds at 3.33% on an oil spike, and an 11 December date nobody voted on today

German yields rose with crude in the morning; the bond desks were already thinking past the count to the next funding deadline.

German government bonds fell on Tuesday morning, which means yields rose. The Bund future slipped 0.13% to 122.5 and the 10-year yield climbed to 3.31%[1], then to about 3.33% by early afternoon, up from 3.29% at Monday's close[2]. The trigger was oil: reports of US strikes on Iran's Qeshm Island in the Strait of Hormuz pushed crude up again, and with it inflation expectations and the odds of another ECB hike[1].

Bond desks were also looking across the Atlantic, though not at the winner. Commerzbank analysts wrote that "Democratic control of Congress should be Treasury-positive on balance", because control of the budget in the House would narrow the room for extra spending[1]. In the same breath they flagged the cost: a higher risk of another government shutdown on 11 December[1].

That is the useful habit for tonight. …

Continue in reading view →

MONEY, FX & COMMITTEES · BRIEF · EPAPER EXTRA, ADDED 17:30 CET

1.118 for the euro, and a 150-point French spread now called normal

The euro traded at about $1.1178 in early afternoon, slightly lower, as the dollar firmed ahead of the US count[2]. ING's strategists expect any move from the midterms to be short-lived; the dollar, they write, still answers mainly to the Fed[1].

The more durable story is at home. French spreads did not benefit from Monday's lower oil price, which ING reads as a sign that levels above 150 basis points "are the new normal now", leaving the euro with a lingering risk premium[1]. ECB speakers since last week's meeting have sounded hawkish, ING adds[1]. Nothing here is investment advice.

This desk's lead is on page 4: 4.09% in a draft, €78.30 a month, and the number that decides it is still on next spring's payslips.

ORDINARY & INHERITED LIFE · SHORT ITEM · EPAPER EXTRA, ADDED 17:30 CET

€1.70 a litre for heating oil, about 80 cents more than a year ago, and a dealer who says buy part

Heating oil edged down a cent on Tuesday. The useful comparison is not yesterday but last November.

If your house runs on an oil tank, Tuesday brought a small mercy: a litre of heating oil cost between €1.70 (esyoil) and €1.76 (Tecson), about a cent less than on Monday[1]. Brent stood at $106.80 a barrel and gasoil at $1,433.25 a tonne that morning, according to HeizOel24[1].

The comparison that matters is the calendar. At the end of October 2025, the Morgenpost notes, a litre cost roughly 80 cents less than today[1]. On esyoil's mid-month averages, the price was €0.92 in mid-February 2026, jumped to €1.34 by mid-March, and has sat at €1.69 to €1.73 since mid-September[1].

esyoil's market commentary does not promise relief. "An end to the high price level is not in sight," it says, and it suggests that anyone who must buy orders only part of a tankful, hoping to top up more cheaply next year[1]. That is a dealer's view, not a forecast to bank on.

Desk arithmetic: 1,000 litres at €1.70 is €1,700; at last November's mid-month €0.95 it would have been €950. The tank is the same size. Only the invoice grew. Nothing here is advice.

ORDINARY & INHERITED LIFE · BRIEF · EPAPER EXTRA, ADDED 17:30 CET

32.02 cents for switchers, 40.39 in basic supply, and a gap that shrank by more than half

On Tuesday the cheapest electricity tariff for a new customer cost 32.02 cents per kWh on the national average, StromAuskunft reports, up 7.20 cents, or 29%, on a year ago and the highest since May 2023[1]. Basic supply (Grundversorgung) moved the other way: 40.39 cents, down from 45.47 a year ago[1].

So the gap between the two has shrunk from 20.65 cents to 8.37 cents per kWh[1]. For a household using 3,500 kWh a year, switching from basic supply to the cheapest tariff would still save about €293 a year on the site's figures, with Thuringia the outlier at €711[1].

The slow tariff absorbed the shock; the fast one passed it on. Neither is a scandal. It is how a price guarantee and a monthly reprice behave in the same storm. Nothing here is advice.

TECH & COMPUTE · 2 MIN

51% not Chinese: Nvidia's new rule for the clouds, given by word of mouth

The chipmaker has reportedly told data-centre partners worldwide to sell most of their new capacity outside China, and the rule exists nowhere on paper.

Nvidia has told its cloud and data-centre partners that at least 51% of the services they sell on new contracts must go to companies that are not Chinese, the Financial Times reported on Tuesday, citing five people familiar with the matter[1]. Existing agreements are untouched[1]. The rule applies to partners worldwide, not only in Asia[2], and Nvidia had not imposed anything like it before[1].

The detail worth noticing is the form. The requirement was passed on verbally, by the sales force and regional teams, not in written documentation[2]. Nvidia neither confirmed nor denied it when AFP asked[1]. In a statement it said that "American chips are the foundation" that American model makers need to compete worldwide, and that US policy encourages cloud providers to build on American infrastructure[2].

The aim is plain enough. Many Chinese AI developers rent computing power from cloud providers outside China, and Washington has tried for years to close that route[1]. Smuggling is the other route; earlier this year senior employees at the server maker Super Micro were charged over about $2.5bn of Nvidia servers sent to China[1].

The cost is plain too. A Singapore-based operator told the FT it is hard to find enough non-Chinese clients outside the US, and that strict enforcement could put its business at risk[3]. A share rule also needs someone to count: what is a "Chinese" customer, who checks, and what happens at 52%?

That is why you should want this written down. Export control works when it is boring: lists, licences, audits, a regulator who can be asked a question. A verbal quota from a supplier may be effective, but it can't be checked, appealed or amended.

WHAT TO WATCH

- Whether Nvidia, or Washington, puts the 51% requirement in writing.
- Cloud operators in Singapore and the Gulf, where the share of Chinese customers is largest, and how they report it.

DESK COMMENT

A rule that cannot be read cannot be audited; the paperwork is the policy.

TECH & COMPUTE · SHORT ITEM · EPAPER EXTRA, ADDED 17:30 CET

74 servers, NT$600 million, and no export charge: Taiwan moves to close the gap

A bill heard in Taipei on Monday would make shipping controlled AI chips to China a crime in its own right, with up to ten years in prison.

In August, prosecutors in Keelung indicted nine people, including staff at the local units of Nvidia and Super Micro, over 74 Nvidia B300 servers allegedly diverted to Chinese buyers for a profit of more than NT$600 million (US$18.5 million)[1]. None of them faces an export charge. The case rests on breach of trust and forged documents, because Taiwanese law had no offence that fitted[1].

That is the gap a bill from the ruling Democratic Progressive Party wants to close. Its amendment to the Foreign Trade Act, heard by parliament's economics committee on Monday, would ban exports of specified chips, key wafer materials, components and chipmaking equipment to mainland China without government approval[1]. Violators would face up to ten years in prison and fines of NT$5–10 million, and the same would apply to shipments routed through a third country[1].

The bill's fate is uncertain. …

Continue in reading view →

TECH & COMPUTE · BRIEF · EPAPER EXTRA, ADDED 17:30 CET

£20 billion of potential, and a power station's shares up 9%

On a day when European tech shares fell 1.6% on AI worries, the AI winner in London was a power company. Drax jumped 9% after partnering with Brookfield and the AI infrastructure platform Radiant to develop a data centre in a project that could attract more than £20 billion ($26.8 billion) of investment[1].

Note the verb: "could". The scarce input in compute is increasingly not chips but a site with a grid connection and steady power, which a power station already has. "All the investments are fuelled by the need for more compute," said Gilles Guibout of BNP Paribas Asset Management, while allowing that some projects could be delayed[1].

HEALTH & CARE · 2 MIN

225, 305, 360: the flu came early, and the jab fits

Flu cases are climbing weeks ahead of the calendar on both sides of the Atlantic, and the first lab check says this year's vaccine matches what is circulating.

Three weeks of numbers from Ontario tell the story in a row: 225 positive flu tests, then 305, then 360 in the week from 18 to 24 October, according to Public Health Ontario figures reported on Tuesday[1]. The province's season began in early September, which is weeks before anyone's planning calendar expects it.

The useful part is the second number. Canada's National Microbiology Laboratory has tested 116 circulating samples against this year's vaccine, and the infectious-diseases specialist Isaac Bogoch called the result "a really good match"[1]. A good match does not mean nobody catches flu. It means the jab you get this week is aimed at the virus actually going round, which is not a given every year.

The United States is seeing the same early start. The CDC estimates flu cases are likely rising in 44 states, and New York's health department reported a 19% weekly rise in mid-October, with flu hospitalisations up from 199 to 233[2]. Experts are watching a G155E mutation in an H1N1 strain as one possible reason for the early start, though it is too soon to say for sure[2]. New York's health commissioner also said fewer residents had been vaccinated than a year earlier, and said people "just need to be reminded"[2].

So the problem is not the science. It is getting people to the clinic. Ontario opened free shots to everyone on 26 October, Toronto is running a combined flu, Covid and RSV clinic on Thursday, and Illinois health officials have tried horror-film memes to get people booked[1,2]. None of that makes headlines. All of it counts.

If your doctor or national guidance says you should have the jab, book it now. Protection takes a little while to build, and in an early season that wait matters more than usual.

WHAT TO WATCH

- Further strain-match results from Canada's National Microbiology Laboratory as more samples are tested
- Whether the early H1N1 rise shows up in European surveillance in the coming weeks

DESK COMMENT

A vaccine that matches is a fine thing. It still only works in an arm.

HEALTH & CARE · SHORT ITEM · EPAPER EXTRA, ADDED 17:30 CET

50,000 people, 92 countries, and the young scoring lowest on vitality

A global survey finds the young doing worst on energy and resilience, while people of every age rate their relationships and sense of meaning highly.

Researchers at Columbia University asked 50,000 people in 92 countries ten questions about how they are doing: competence, optimism, self-esteem, engagement, vitality and more. The results, published in *Social Indicators Research*, point to young people as the group dragging global scores down, mainly through lower vitality, emotional stability and resilience[1].

There is a quieter finding that gets less attention. Relationships, meaning, competence, engagement and self-esteem were the highest-scoring dimensions[1]. People tend to rate their own lives better than the world around them, which the authors link to the familiar "optimism gap"[1].

The everyday factors behave as you would expect. Being in work, earning more and living with other people all went with better scores, and there was no point at which more resources stopped helping. Each extra level of education was linked to higher well-being, and hybrid workers scored better than fully remote ones[1].

Continue in reading view →

HEALTH & CARE · BRIEF · EPAPER EXTRA, ADDED 17:30 CET

49% say AI worries weigh on them; 33% say the workload went up

A survey of 1,000 US adults by the Sylvia Brafman Mental Health Center found that 49% said worries about AI had harmed their mental health or well-being. Among Gen Z respondents the figure was 71%, against 28% of baby boomers[1].

The detail worth noticing is about behaviour. 64% said they had done something in the past year to prove their value, such as working extra hours, taking on unpaid duties or answering messages after hours. 42% said AI made them faster, while 33% said they were then expected to produce more[1].

These are self-reported answers, as the researchers point out, not measured working conditions[1]. Still, a clear job description and a manager who explains the plan cost little to provide.

SECURITY & ORDER · 2 MIN

50°C in the freezers, ten countries, and a patch from August

Monday's attacks on supermarket refrigeration across Europe were not clever, which is exactly why the boring fix matters.

On Monday, supermarkets in at least ten European countries found their freezers warming up. Belgium, Estonia, Finland, Ireland, Italy, Luxembourg, the Netherlands, Portugal, Germany and Sweden all reported problems, temperatures reportedly reached 50°C, and stock had to be thrown away[1]. This came three weeks after an attack hit as many as 700 French grocery stores[1]. Nobody has claimed responsibility[1].

The numbers are concrete. Delhaize had dozens of stores affected in Belgium and Luxembourg, Carrefour 15 Belgian stores, and Intermarché 15 of its 153 in Belgium. Thirteen SuperValu stores were hit in Ireland and seven Intermarché stores in Portugal[1,2]. Belgium's federal prosecutors have opened an investigation, and the European Commission convened its inter-institutional task force with ENISA and Europol on Tuesday morning[1,2].

This is not a story about sophisticated attackers. Italy's government said the affected businesses mostly had "obsolete" systems with interfaces exposed to the internet and weak authentication[1]. The Swedish adviser Fredrik Blix said the control units "sit directly on the public internet". In his account, the vendor patched the flaw in August, but thousands of units never got the update and the oldest cannot be updated at all[2]. Some retailers traced the problem to outside companies that manage their refrigeration. In western Germany, a Rewe store's outage was linked to an attack on the system provider Danfoss[1].

Who is behind it remains unknown, and the Commission's spokesman declined to attribute blame[1]. Guessing does not protect a single freezer. What does is an inventory of which devices are online, who holds the passwords and when the last update was installed. Britain's NCSC has already told retailers to update their fridge temperature controls[1].

If you run a shop, a kitchen or a care home with remotely monitored equipment, ask your service company one question this week: is our controller reachable from the internet, and is it patched?

WHAT TO WATCH

- Findings from Belgium's federal prosecutors and the EU task force with ENISA and Europol
- Whether national agencies follow the UK's NCSC in telling retailers to update refrigeration controls

DESK COMMENT

The cheapest defence is the update you already received.

SECURITY & ORDER · SHORT ITEM · EPAPER EXTRA, ADDED 17:30 CET

Seven files for Wednesday, 38 more by Christmas

The Bundestag budget committee takes Bundeswehr proposals 63 to 69 on 4 November, from Eurofighter contract changes to training rounds for the Puma.

Defence spending gets debated in speeches but approved in files. On Wednesday, 4 November, the Bundestag budget committee has seven so-called €25-million proposals before it, all funded from the defence budget, Einzelplan 14[1].

The list is practical. It includes another change to the Eurofighter production contract, which currently covers 38 Tranche 4 and 20 Tranche 5 aircraft. There are further night-vision attachments for rifles from an existing framework deal, and troposcatter radios that link network nodes without line of sight[1]. …

Continue in reading view →

SECURITY & ORDER · BRIEF · EPAPER EXTRA, ADDED 17:30 CET

Nine flights, two nights, one drone problem, and Guernsey takes notes

Drone activity near Jersey Airport on Friday evening kept four planes from landing. One flight was cancelled and three were diverted back to the mainland. On Saturday evening, despite a police appeal that morning, five more flights were disrupted, including one from Funchal that ended up in Paris[1].

Jersey says "additional measures" are now in place, without giving details for operational reasons. Police are trying to identify those responsible, and under Jersey's aviation law, recklessly or negligently endangering an aircraft can bring up to five years in prison[1].

The sensible response came from next door. Guernsey Airport says it is reviewing its response planning and risk management with the relevant authorities[1]. It is a modest step, but it is how airports are meant to learn from each other.

CLIMATE & WEATHER · 2 MIN

23.69 inches in Grant-Valkaria: a 1-in-100 flood on the Space Coast, on polling day

Florida's Brevard County took two feet of rain from a storm that outran its forecast, and the polling stations moved before the water did.

The numbers from Florida's Atlantic coast read like a typo. Grant-Valkaria in Brevard County recorded 23.69 inches of rain, Malabar 23.44 and Palm Bay 19.75, according to preliminary National Weather Service reports compiled by WKMG in Orlando[1]. Desk conversion: 23.69 inches is about 602 millimetres. Some parts of the county saw a 1-in-100-year flood, the station's chief meteorologist wrote[1].

CLIMATE & WEATHER · FLORIDA

Two feet of rain on the Space Coast, a third of that inland

Rain totals of the Central Florida storm from Sunday 1 Nov to Tuesday morning 3 Nov 2026, millimetres · preliminary NWS Melbourne reports

▶ Data table

Source: National Weather Service Melbourne, preliminary rain reports, as published by WKMG ClickOrlando (3 Nov 2026, 08:33 EST / 14:33 CET); inches converted to millimetres by the desk (1 in = 25.4 mm); retrieved 3 Nov 2026 · Preliminary, subject to revision. · CSV

It was a local storm, and that is the point. The heaviest totals sit in a strip of southern Brevard. Melbourne had 13.11 inches and Kennedy Space Center 9.74; inland, Lake Harney in Seminole County had 8.44 and Eatonville in Orange County 7.43[1]. The cause was unglamorous: an upper-level disturbance and persistent easterly winds feeding rounds of rain from Sunday[1]. One forecaster said the storm "exceeded everyone's expectations"[2].

Continue in reading view →

WHAT TO WATCH

- The final National Weather Service rain totals, which replace the preliminary reports and may move the record.
- The lower Mississippi valley, where forecasters warned of scattered flash floods on Tuesday as the system moved east.

DESK COMMENT

A forecast is an estimate; a rain gauge is a receipt. Both are worth keeping.

CLIMATE & WEATHER · SHORT ITEM · EPAPER EXTRA, ADDED 17:30 CET

More than 100 homes under water in Camp Verde, and many without flood cover

Record rain in normally dry Arizona sent Beaver Creek over its banks, and the bill falls on households that never thought to insure against water.

Arizona is not where you expect a flood. On Sunday night, Beaver Creek broke its banks in Camp Verde and more than 100 homes were under water; as it receded on Monday, most were destroyed, AZFamily reported[1]. …

Continue in reading view →

CLIMATE & WEATHER · BRIEF · EPAPER EXTRA, ADDED 17:30 CET

Minus one in Bavaria, and frost warnings across the south

Winter knocked early on Tuesday. The Deutscher Wetterdienst issued level-one frost warnings for several Bavarian districts from midnight, in places until 06:00, with temperatures around −1°C, the Augsburger Allgemeine reported[1]. Baden-Württemberg, Thuringia and Saxony were also covered by the frost warning[1].

Daytime brought little relief: dense, high-fog-like cloud over Swabia, Upper Bavaria and the Danube, with highs of only 3°C in the Allgäu to 8°C on the lower Danube[1]. Where skies clear, light frost is possible locally, and freezing wet roads can turn slippery in higher Alpine valleys[1].

The useful advice is the dull one: leave a few minutes early to scrape the windscreen, and drive gently on damp, cold roads[1].

Charts and data

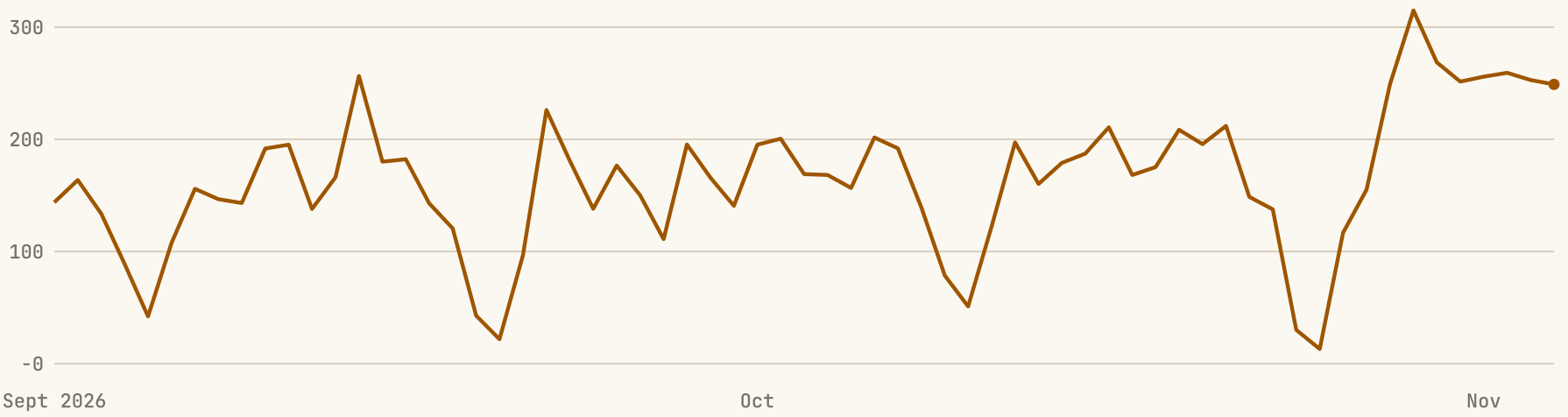
ENERGY · POWER

Six days above €250, then €248.99

Germany/Luxembourg day-ahead electricity price, daily average by delivery day, € per MWh

Day-ahead DE-LU

All



▶ Data table (latest values)

Source: Bundesnetzagentur | SMARD.de, day-ahead price DE-LU (filter 4169), delivery days 1 Sep to 4 Nov 2026; 4 Nov is the desk average of the 24 hourly results of the 3 Nov auction, retrieved 3 Nov 2026, 16:25 CET · CC BY 4.0 · CSV

Latest values

SERIES	VALUE	DATE	CHART
Day-ahead DE-LU	248.99	4 Nov 2026	Six days above €250, then €248.99

Last data point of each series in the charts above, from the Inside Desk data archive. Sources under each chart.

Before you close the tab

THE DAY IN ONE SENTENCE

Pensions could rise about 4% next July, but the real number will be worked out in spring from what people actually earned this year.

ONE THING YOU CAN DO THIS WEEK

Find your last pension statement or payslip and write one number on a card: your monthly gross pension, or your monthly gross pay. When the spring figure for July arrives, or the 2028 contribution rate is settled, you will know in a minute what it means for you, without reading a single forecast in between.

A habit, not advice.

WHAT WENT RIGHT

A cancer treatment built for one patient at a time has passed its first large test. In the INTerpath-001 trial of 1,137 people whose high-risk melanoma had been removed, adding a personalised mRNA treatment, intismeran autogene, to the immunotherapy Keytruda cut the risk of the cancer returning or of death by 42% over about two years [1]. At two years, 82.2% of patients on the combination were cancer-free, against 70% on Keytruda alone, with no new safety concerns [1]. It is still investigational, and survival data are not in yet; the makers plan to file with regulators [1]. Slow trials, careful numbers, and a door opened.

IN EUROS AT HOME

The draft pension report expects a rise of 4.09% on 1 July 2027, which the FAZ puts at about €41 more for every €1,000 of monthly gross pension, and €78.30 a month for the standard pension of 45 average years [2][3]. Desk arithmetic: a gross pension of €1,200 a month would rise by about €49, and one of €1,500 by about €61, if the estimate holds. It is a draft: last year's estimate of 3.73% became 4.24% [3].

Desk arithmetic on a draft estimate, before tax and health and care contributions. The final rise is set in spring. Nothing here is advice.

SMALL WORDS

Haltelinie

The "holding line": a legal floor that keeps the statutory pension level at 48% of average earnings, before tax, until 2031 [2][3]. When the normal formula would let pensions fall behind wages, the holding line tops up the rise, and the federal budget refunds the extra cost, put at €1.7 billion in 2027 [3].

1. Personalized mRNA treatment reduces melanoma recurrence in landmark Phase 3 trial — Inova Newsroom, 2 Nov 2026
2. Regierung erwartet 2027 Rentenerhöhung von mehr als vier Prozent — Frankfurter Allgemeine Zeitung, 3 Nov 2026, 14:18 CET
3. Entwurf: Renten könnten 2027 um 4,09 Prozent steigen — Reuters via onvista, 3 Nov 2026, 14:57 CET

Commentary for information only. Not investment, legal, tax, medical or political advice. Inside Desk is free and reader-supported. Every number is sourced in the piece it appears in.